

GREAT VALUE — LSO RUNBOOK

*GREAT VALUE — Imperial Fists · Emperor's Shield + Librarian Conclave
Lone Star Open (LSO) — 300+ players, Swiss
Generated 2026-07-27 (11E, post-Dataslate)*

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THE LIST

Detachments: Emperor's Shield (2 DP) + Librarian Conclave (1 DP) = 3 DP

Disposition: Purge the Foe (kill-weighted — fits the durable convergence gunline). Hidden deploy + reserve-heavy teleport/deep-strike alpha.

Points: ~1,985 / 2000 (the friend's actual build). Points MFM-verified where present; * = SM MFM is missing Sternguard / Land Speeder / Vanguard Veterans (same incompleteness we hit for Knights) so those are meta-doc estimates — have him confirm exact points/counts vs his app.

A REVERSE-KNIGHT: instead of 5-6 big models, ~50-60 elite bodies that are hard to kill and hard to move. The win-con is CONVERGENCE, not raw guns: Oath of Moment names ONE enemy unit/turn and the whole army re-rolls Hits + adds +1 to Wound into it — roughly DOUBLING every unit's output onto that target. Wrapped around an OC22 Terminator brick (Lysander) that one-rounds anything in melee, an unsaveable Sternguard Dev-Wound chipper, AP-2 cyclone missiles, and mobile Land Speeder melta. Defence: 2+/4++ (the real workhorse) + sticky objectives + hidden deploy. It rarely gets tabled and rarely gets out-scored — it grinds you down and holds what it takes. NOTE: Armour of Contempt is NOT army-wide durability — it's a 1-CP Strat that blunts ONE attacker's AP-by-1 on ONE unit, once per phase, and only helps vs AP-1/-2 (nothing vs high-AP/invuln/Dev). With only ~1 CP/turn it's an occasional, well-timed tool, not a passive.

- **10x Terminator Assault Squad (TH/SS) (310)** — + Darnath Lysander + Ancient in Terminator Armour = the OC22 BRICK. Thunder hammer S8 AP-2 D2 [Dev]; ~24-28 melee one-rounds ANY target. M5, Teleport Homer. NOT battle-shock-immune (see below).
- **1x Darnath Lysander (100)** — Warlord. Inspiring Commander -> non-Character Terminators become OC2 (brick = OC22 while intact). Icon of Obstinacy (-1 to wound at S>=5). Gives NO battle-shock immunity.
- **1x Ancient in Terminator Armour (65)** — Banner: +OC + re-roll a hit/wound; keeps the brick fighting on death.
- **10x Terminator Squad (2x Cyclone) (320)** — + Librarian in Terminator Armour [Fusillade]. #1 RANGED threat: krak missile S9 AP-2 + cyclone; Fusillade = Lethal Hits. ~one-shots an Armiger.
- **1x Librarian in Terminator Armour (75)** — Leads the cyclone brick; Fusillade (Lethal Hits) + a Conclave Discipline/round.
- **10x Sternguard Veteran Squad (~170*)** — + Librarian [Temporal Corridor]. The UNSAVEABLE chipper: Sternguard bolt rifle S4 AP-1 D1 [Dev, RF1] + FULL wound-reroll vs Oath -> ~5-7 mortal wounds/turn skipping any invuln. It

CLEARs W1/W2 UNITS wholesale — but has NO Precision, so it can't snipe an attached Character; that's Lysander + Epic Challenge in melee.

- **1x Librarian (~65*)** — Temporal Corridor (move-the-Sternguard reserve/reposition) + a Discipline.
- **2x Land Speeder (Multi-melta) (~180*)** — Multi-melta S9 AP-4 D6 [Melta 2], 2 shots ea. Armiger/vehicle killer. HAVE DEEP STRIKE (a 3rd arrival threat). M14 mobile.
- **5x Intercessor Squad (80)** — T4 W2 OC10 STICKY (Objective Secured / Wrathful Conquerors) — the objective stays his after they die. Bolt rifle volume.
- **5x Bladeguard Veteran Squad (80)** — 3+/4++ OC + Teleport Homer; forward pressure / brick support.
- **2x Vanguard Veteran Squad (Jump) (~180*)** — OC5, M12, Teleport Homers — army-wide OC + forward homers that enable the teleport alpha.

THE TAPESTRY — how it wins

- **Oath of Moment (THE engine)** — Each Command phase name ONE enemy unit -> the whole army re-rolls Hits AND (mono-IF) adds +1 to Wound into it. ~DOUBLES every unit's damage onto the Oathed target. Convergence, not raw guns, is how GV kills.
- **Lysander — Inspiring Commander** — Non-Character Terminators in his unit become OC2 -> the 10-brick is OC20 (+Lysander +Ancient = OC22) WHILE INTACT. It won't take a Command-phase battle-shock test until below half strength (6+ dead), so vs most armies the OC22 holds. But Lysander grants NO battle-shock immunity: a FORCED test (see Battle-shock entry) can shock it at full strength -> OC drops to '-' (0), so all that OC evaporates.
- **Wrath of Dorn (Emperor's Shield)** — Re-roll a Wound-roll of 1 army-wide + FULL wound re-roll for Lysander's unit. Stacks with Oath.
- **Armour of Contempt (defence)** — -1 AP to incoming attacks (stratagem). Drops enemy AP-2 -> AP-1; brutal vs AP-1/-2 VOLUME (the common case). BUT does NOTHING vs AP-4/-5 (armour already negated) or whenever you're taking an INVULN save (AP never modifies an invuln), and NOTHING vs Devastating/mortal wounds -- so it does not save you from railguns/fusion/Dev spikes.
- **Sternguard Focus (unsaveable)** — vs the Oathed unit, Sternguard get FULL wound re-roll -> every crit-6 = a Devastating mortal wound. ~5-7 mortals/turn that skip ANY invuln/Ion Shield. Their teleport-arrival turn is their WEAKEST shoot.
- **Teleport / Deep-Strike engines** — THREE arrival threats: Sternguard teleport (Temporal Corridor), Land Speeder Deep Strike, Teleport-Homer jumps (Vanguard/Bladeguard). Reserve-heavy hidden alpha lands turn 2 within homer range.
- **Librarius Conclave** — Each round pick 1 Discipline; ALL friendly ADEPTUS ASTARTES PSYKER units get it until end of round (that's the Librarian-led Sternguard + the Librarian-in-Term cyclone brick — NOT the Lysander brick, it has no psyker). Verified from the pack: Biomancy = +2" M / Divination = re-roll Hit-1s AND Wound-1s / Pyromancy = +1 AP vs enemies within 12" / Telekinesis = -1 S to ranged attacks INTO the unit (defensive) / Telepathy = ignore BS/WS/hit-roll modifiers. Fusillade Enhancement makes the bearer's ranged

attacks [LETHAL HITS], +[SUSTAINED HITS 1] if the unit also has Pyromancy. Typical pick: Pyromancy (turns the cyclone brick into +1 AP + Lethal + Sustained into the Oath target) or Divination for reliability.

- **The alpha math** — Full-stack into an Oathed target ~30-34 (10+ unsaveable Sternguard Dev); the Lysander brick (full Wrath re-roll + Oath) ~49 melee -> one-rounds ANY single model, even a 4++.
- **The soft underbelly** — Everything hangs on the SOFT LEGS (Sternguard, Land Speeders, cyclone Termies, Vanguard) + the 2 SLOW M5 bricks. Kill the legs -> the convergence collapses; out-mobile the bricks -> the board opens.
- **Killing characters (NO Precision)** — Sternguard/cyclone/brick have NO [PRECISION] -> you canNOT snipe a Character attached to a Bodyguard unit (wounds hit the bodyguard). Tools: (1) grind the whole unit down with Oath volume, exposing the char; (2) EPIC CHALLENGE (core strat 15.03, 1CP) -> Lysander's Fist gains [PRECISION] to assassinate an ATTACHED char in MELEE; (3) STANDALONE Monster/Titanic chars (Fulgrim/Magnus/Lion/superheavy) = shoot DIRECTLY. Oath the UNIT, not the character.
- **CP economy (~2/round)** — 1 CP at the start of EACH player-turn (~10/game) + CP-model/discard extras. Oath of Moment is FREE (army rule). BUT Armour of Contempt, Fury of the First, Disciplined Extermination, Dropship Extraction, Wrathful Conquerors AND Epic Challenge all COMPETE for ~1 strat/turn -> you cannot fire them all. Each turn pick ONE priority: the offence convergence strat, OR defensive AoC, OR Epic Challenge -- and hold CP for the swing turns.
- **Battle-shock — GV's HIDDEN weakness** — Core 01.07: a battle-shocked unit has OC '-' (0), CANNOT be targeted by ANY stratagem, and cannot do/finish Actions. GV's ENTIRE win-con is the OC22 brick out-scoring you on objectives -> shock it and that collapses, AND you shut off his defensive strats on it (no AoC/Rotate-equivalent on a shocked unit). Lysander gives NO immunity. His mitigations: Insane Bravery (core 15.04, 1CP, auto-pass ONE test -> competes for the same CP as everything else) and staying above half strength (no voluntary test). WEAPONIZERS to expect at LSO that FORCE tests at full strength: Tyranids (Shadow in the Warp = -1 Ld / forced tests near synapse), CSM (Dread Talons / Fear-based -1 & forced), Necrons (forced-test tech), Chaos Daemons (terror/forced). Against those decks the OC22 is NOT reliable -- plan for it to drop to OC0 on a bad round.
- **Core strats cut BOTH ways** — Every army at LSO has the same 12 core stratagems (Section 15): Command Re-roll, Counter-offensive, Epic Challenge, Insane Bravery, Grenade, Tank Shock, Fire Overwatch, Smokescreen, Heroic Intervention, Rapid Ingress, Go to Ground, Armour of Contempt. So the OPPONENT can Epic-Challenge to snipe GV's characters in melee too, Counter-offensive to fight first, Rapid Ingress to steal the alpha, and Fire Overwatch the teleport drop. GV isn't the only one with these tricks -- budget CP for the enemy's core plays, not just your own.

Mindset

GV is 'always outnumbered by big things, never out-graunched by small ones.' You are the DURABLE, STICKY, all-comers list — you rarely get tabled and rarely get out-scored. Play the OATH like a sniper (one perfect target/turn), weather the

enemy's alpha behind 2+/4++ (Armour of Contempt helps only vs AP-1/-2 volume, NOT railguns/fusion/Dev), and win the LONG GAME on sticky objectives + attrition. Your THREE failure modes: (1) getting out-BODIED/out-OC'd by a true horde, (2) getting out-MANOEUVRED and out-scored by a faster army while your M5 bricks are stranded, and (3) getting BATTLE-SHOCKED by a shock-weaponizer (Tyranids/CSM/Necrons/Daemons) -> the OC22 brick drops to OC0 and its defensive strats switch off. Deploy your homers to control WHERE the alpha lands; hold 1 CP for Insane Bravery vs shock decks; never waste the Oath on a target you can't finish.

Realistic record

Great Value is a STRONG all-comers list — a better raw record expectation than a Knight army because it has FEWER hard counters. Realistic 300+ GT: a solidly positive record, ~4-2 to 5-1 over 5-6 rounds, with a genuine shot at the top tables. It wins by DURABILITY + CONVERGENCE + STICKY OBJECTIVES, not by any single alpha. The two things that beat it: a true HORDE that out-bodies the OC (Orks) and a fast army that out-manoeuvres the M5 bricks and out-scores while refusing the fight (kite-and-flip). Its own discipline test: pilot the Oath perfectly (one finishable target/turn) and don't strand the bricks. Blind spots: (1) M5 bricks are slow -> board control depends on the mobile legs + homers, protect them; (2) psyker-dependent (Conclave) -> Culexus/Callidus/character-snipes throttle it, screen the Librarians; (3) reserve-heavy -> a whiffed turn-2 arrival (failed charges / scattered homers) is a lost tempo swing.

FAVOURABLE (bank these): Emperor's Children, AdMech, T'au Retaliation, Blood Angels, Drukhari, Astra Militarum

COIN-FLIP (practice): Custodes, Dark Angels Deathwing, Necrons C'tan (lean unfav)

HARDEST (accept ~45%): Orks Green Tide

SIM VERIFICATION (data-driven)

800 games/archetype. GV's Oath-boosted convergence output computed from real 11e profiles (data/bsdata via wh.mathhammer); enemy pressure + objectives meta-calibrated. tools/mc_gv_sim.py.

Archetype	Prev.	Verdict	Oath dmg	Brick	GV win%
Emperor's Children (Defiler+s warm)	9	FAV	15	35	61%
Orks (Green Tide horde)	8	COIN	34	61	27%
AdMech (Rad-Zone gunline)	6	FAV	29	46	77%
T'au (Retaliation alpha)	5	COIN	14	30	66%
Necrons (Awakened C'tan)	4	COIN-	13	29	33%
Custodes (elite melee)	4	COIN	17	36	67%
Blood Angels (jump alpha)	4	FAV	30	46	67%
Dark Angels (Deathwing)	3	COIN	17	36	77%
Drukhari (Skysplinter)	3	FAV	21	41	78%
Astra Militarum (superheavy)	2	FAV	16	30	74%

Prevalence-weighted GV win rate across the top meta $\approx$ 59% — a strong all-comers list. (Indicative, not gospel; the coin-flips are the matchups to practice.)

BATTLE PLANS

Emperor's Children — Frenzied Host / Coterie (Defiler + swarm)

FAVOURABLE · *Prevalence: High (9)*

Deciding factor: Your 2+/4++ + Armour of Contempt tanks the Infractor/Daemonette melee that shreds W1 armies; Oath + Sternguard Dev delete the Defilers and the Lord Exultants; the brick one-rounds Fulgrim/Keeper if they commit. Their AP-1/-2 volume is the wrong shape for TEQ.

Game plan:

- Oath the Defiler each turn (it's the only thing that hurts your armour) — Sternguard Dev + cyclone remove one/turn.
- Let the Daemonette/Infractor chaff crash into the brick; it holds and swings back for ~49. Don't chase.
- Sticky your objectives; grind. They can't out-durable or out-score you — win on attrition.

Watch for: Fulgrim (Fights First, -1 to hit) + Maulerfiends can trade into a brick; Oath them before they charge.

Orks — Green Tide (~100 bodies)

COIN-FLIP (your hardest common matchup) · *Prevalence: High (8)*

Deciding factor: The ONE army that out-BODIES and out-OCs you. ~100 Boyz + 5++ + power claws flood the board; your OC22 brick holds 1-2 objectives but they blanket the rest, and claws crack even Terminators. Your shooting mows Boyz but can't clear 100.

Game plan:

- Do NOT try to out-OC the horde — concede the middle, hold your 2 bricks' objectives + sticky what you can.
- Oath the biggest brick each turn (Ghazghkull's or the klaw-nob unit); shooting-focus to thin the OC where it decides an objective.
- Bricks counter-punch (they survive the claws better than anything); Speeders melta the Kill Rigs/Wazdakka. Race secondaries — you won't out-primary a full horde.

Watch for: Getting tar-pitted and out-actioned; Green Tide is a genuine ~45% — accept it and minimise the margin.

Adeptus Mechanicus — Rad-Zone / Lords of the Forge gunline

FAVOURABLE · *Prevalence: High (6)*

Deciding factor: Their anti-tank is WASTED on you: Kataphron arc rifle [Anti-Vehicle 4+] and ferrumite do nothing special to INFANTRY, and D6-damage guns

over-kill W2-3 bodies. You out-durable (AoC + 2+/4++), out-volume, and Oath deletes a Kataphron brick/turn.

Game plan:

- Oath a Kataphron brick each turn — Sternguard Dev + cyclone + Speeder melta erase it (no invuln/FNP).
- Advance into their M5 gunline; Armour of Contempt shrugs the ferrumite/lascannon. Brick eats Kastelan/Ironstriders in melee.
- Out-score — their bodies are few and fragile once the Kataphrons die.

Watch for: Culexus/Callidus sniping your psykers (throttles Conclave); screen the Librarians.

T'au Empire — Retaliation Cadre (fusion/rail alpha)

COIN-FLIP -> favourable (the alpha is REAL) · *Prevalence: High (5)*

Deciding factor: Their anti-elite is Railgun AP-5 / heavy rail AP-4 / fusion AP-4 — NO AP-1, so ARMOUR OF CONTEMPT DOES NOTHING here (AP that high already negates armour; an invuln is never modified by AP). You're on the 4++ ALONE (fails half), and the railgun/rail DEVASTATING WOUNDS turn crits into MORTALS that bypass the 4++ too — a markerlit alpha CAN delete the brick. Your edge isn't your saves, it's RESERVES (few T1 targets) + T'au fragility: Oath one-rounds Crisis/Riptides and the brick walks down anything that lingers. Survive the alpha, then out-grind.

Game plan:

- Reserve heavy + hide the brick from first-turn rail/fusion LoS — the alpha can't hurt what it can't see. (Don't waste CP on Armour of Contempt vs their AP-4/-5; it does nothing.)
- In YOUR Command phase each turn, Oath the biggest suit unit ON THE BOARD (Sternguard Dev + cyclone + brick erase it). You commit PROACTIVELY — you CANNOT Oath a unit the turn it deep-strikes in (that's the opponent's turn).
- Grind forward; T'au can't out-durable or out-melee you. Kill markerlight Pathfinders to cut the hit-buffs; make them Fire-and-Fade off objectives.

Watch for: Railgun/heavy rail are DEVASTATING WOUNDS -> crit MORTALS bypass your 4++, and AP-4/-5 makes armour moot, so a markerlit rail turn chunks the brick. Keep Terminators spread to limit MORTAL-WOUND SPILLOVER — NOT for 'Blast' (the railgun isn't a Blast weapon, and Blast counts MODELS in the unit, not their spacing, so spreading doesn't reduce it).

Necrons — Awakened Dynasty (C'tan + Wraiths)

COIN-FLIP (lean unfavourable) · *Prevalence: Med (4)*

Deciding factor: C'tan durability (4++/-1Dmg/reanim) blunts even your convergence, and they out-OC with reanimating bodies. Your edge: Sternguard Dev MORTALS partly bypass reanimation, and the brick out-fights Wraiths. But you can't table 3 C'tan and they grind objectives.

Game plan:

- Oath + Sternguard Dev a C'tan each turn — mortals skip the 4++; you won't kill it but you suppress it.
- Don't feed the brick into the Void Dragon (Anti-Veh, heals off you); brick kills Wraiths/Lychguard instead.
- Win on sticky objectives + secondaries; it's a grind you can steal, not a matchup you dominate.

Watch for: Reanimation refunding your chip — focus-remove whole units, don't spread. BATTLE-SHOCK: their 1CP C'tan strat forces the OC22 brick to test at -1 (+D3+1 mortals on fail) -> a failed test zeroes its OC and shuts off its strats on the turn you most need it holding. Hold 1 CP for Insane Bravery when the brick is contesting a key objective.

Adeptus Custodes — Lions of the Emperor (elite melee)

COIN-FLIP · *Prevalence: Med (4)*

Deciding factor: Mirror of elites: their 2+/4++ + better melee weapons vs your 2+/4++ + more bodies + Oath + unsaveable Sternguard. They out-fight the brick model-for-model; you out-number and out-shoot (Dev bypasses their 4++).

Game plan:

- Do NOT brawl the Blade Champion/Wardens with the brick head-on — Oath + Sternguard Dev SHOOT them down (mortals skip the 4++).
- Use your body count + sticky OC to out-score; they have ~40 models, you have more.
- Speeders melta the Caladius; cyclone + Oath delete a Custodian unit/turn.

Watch for: Trajann/Blade Champion out-duel Lysander AND are ATTACHED (you can't snipe them) — grind the whole unit down with Oath volume, or use EPIC CHALLENGE (1CP) to give Lysander's Fist [PRECISION] and kill the character in melee. Don't feed Lysander in unbuffed.

Blood Angels — Stormlance / Liberator jump alpha

FAVOURABLE · *Prevalence: Med (4)*

Deciding factor: Glass melee alpha into your armour: Death Company/Sang Guard hit hard on the charge but fold to return fire, and Armour of Contempt + 4++ blunts their AP. Oath + overwatch thin the alpha as it lands; the brick counter-punches.

Game plan:

- Screen so the DC/Sang Guard land 9"+ out and can't reach a T2 charge (overwatch thins them). Then on YOUR turn Oath the landed unit and gun it down — you can't Oath it as it arrives in their turn.
- Weather the charge behind 2+/4++/AoC; the brick one-rounds Dante/Sanguinary Guard back.
- Out-grind — they're fragile once the alpha is spent.

Watch for: Lemartes/Priests are ATTACHED to the DC/Sang-Guard (you CANNOT target them) — grind the whole unit down with Oath volume, or Lysander + EPIC CHALLENGE (1CP -> [PRECISION]) to assassinate the buff-char in melee.

Dark Angels — Deathwing Knights / Inner Circle

COIN-FLIP · *Prevalence: Med (3-4)*

Deciding factor: Terminator mirror: their Deathwing Knights (4++, mace, Smite of the Watchers) + Lion vs your Lysander brick + Sternguard. Both durable; comes down to Oath efficiency + who out-scores. The Lion out-duels Lysander in melee.

Game plan:

- SHOOT the Deathwing down with Oath + Sternguard Dev (mortals skip the 4+ +) — don't melee the mace brick.
- Race objectives; both armies are slow, so board position + sticky OC decide it.
- Speeders + cyclone delete the Ravenwing speeders / support first.

Watch for: The Lion is a STANDALONE Monster (directly targetable) — Oath + shoot him down at range (no Precision needed). Do NOT feed Lysander into him in melee.

Drukhari — Skysplinter Assault (fast splinter + lance)

FAVOURABLE · *Prevalence: Med (3)*

Deciding factor: Fragile paper into your armour: their dark lances are few and their Lethal/pain tokens are non-Vehicle (do little to TEQ); Armour of Contempt + 4++ tanks the splinter. Oath + volume deletes their transports and infantry wholesale.

Game plan:

- Oath a Venom/Ravager or the Incubi each turn — shooting erases their paper.
- Weather the T2 lance alpha behind AoC; brick counter-charges the Incubi/Wyches.
- Their speed can out-manoeuvre — hold sticky objectives so they can't just flip the board late.

Watch for: Being out-actioned by their mobility; keep your homers/screens tight so they can't backfield-raid.

Astra Militarum — Steel Hammer superheavy / artillery

FAVOURABLE · *Prevalence: Low-Med (2)*

Deciding factor: Their lascannon/volcano over-kills your W2-3 bodies (D6 into W2 = waste), and their infantry can't out-fight yours. You advance behind AoC, Oath the superheavies (or ignore and out-score), and the brick/Speeders crack the tanks.

Game plan:

- Reserve vs the alpha; advance into the gunline (they're static). Oath the Shadowsword/Baneblade or just out-score around it.
- Speeder melta + brick delete a superheavy if it's the win-con; otherwise take objectives their tanks can't hold.
- Sticky OC + body count out-scores a low-model Guard tank list.

Watch for: Artillery + Leontus orders can chip. Spread bodies to limit mortal/spillover from the big guns — but note spreading does NOT reduce a

[BLAST] weapon's shots (Blast = +1 attack per 5 models IN the target unit, regardless of spacing); to cut Blast you bring smaller units.

APPENDIX — VERIFIED PROFILES (the numbers behind the sim)

- **Sternguard Bolt Rifle:** 24" | 2 | S4 | AP-1 | D1 | Assault, Dev Wounds, Heavy, RF1 — vs Oath = full wound re-roll -> ~5-7 unsaveable mortals/turn.
- **Cyclone missile (krak):** S9 | AP-2 | + Lethal Hits (Fusillade) — Persistent AP-2 anti-Knight/elite; ~one-shots an Armiger with Oath.
- **Thunder Hammer (brick):** Melee | 3 | S8 | AP-2 | D2 | Dev Wounds — 10-brick + Lysander (full Wrath re-roll + Oath) ~49 dmg -> one-rounds anything.
- **Lysander — Fist of Dorn:** Melee | 5 | S10 | AP-3 | D3 | Dev Wounds — Character-killer via EPIC CHALLENGE (1CP -> [PRECISION]): assassinate an ATTACHED enemy Character in melee.
- **Land Speeder — Multi-melta:** 24" | 2 | S9 | AP-4 | D6 | Melta 2 — x2 Speeders, Deep Strike; Armiger/vehicle killer (Oath ~doubles).
- **Intercessor Bolt Rifle:** 24" | 2 | S4 | AP-1 | D1 | Assault, Heavy — Sticky OC10 body + volume chaff-clear.